United Nations Development Programme

Kosovo

Initiation Plan

Project Title:	Kosovo Climate Promise Project - 2
Expected UNSDCF/CPD Outcome(s):	By 2025, women and men in Kosovo[1], particularly youth and vulnerable groups, have increased access to decent work and benefit from sustainable and inclusive economic development that is more resilient to impacts of climate change, disasters, and emergencies.
Expected CPD Output(s):	Output 2.3: Enhanced climate change and green investment strategies; Output 2.4: Enhanced capacities in monitoring, forecasting and early warning for climate risks and disasters.
Initiation Plan Start/End Dates:	July 2023 – July 2024
Implementing Partner:	UNDP Kosovo

Brief Description

Kosovo is set to voluntarily adopt the Paris Agreement and draft NDCs, demonstrating its commitment to the global climate agenda. Kosovo's political status coupled with its non-member status in the UN, has resulted in a delayed processes both in climate mitigation and adaptation. UNDP's work through Climate Promise is being transformational, contributing to the development of the first Climate Change Law, which is set to be approved by the government, and the functionalization of the interministerial Climate Change Councill.

The region is considered one of the world's climate change hotspots, facing limited capacity to adapt. The urgent need to address climate change is crucial as extreme weather events, including floods, are expected to intensify. Kosovo heavily relies on non-renewable energy sources, causing air pollution and health risks. The project aims to enhance collaboration, support the advancement of the Climate Change Council functions, develop voluntary NDCs, and institutionalize continue supporting just transition through mechanisms for upskilling labour. By prioritizing mitigation, adaptation, and green financing, Kosovo can work towards a sustainable future.

Programme Period:	_____
Project Number:	_____
Output Number:	_____
Gender Marker:	Gen 2

Total resources required	350,000$
Total allocated resources:	_____
• Regular	_____
• Other:	
○ Donor	_____
○ Donor	_____
○ Government	_____
Unfunded budget:	_____
In-kind Contributions	_____

[1] References to Kosovo shall be understood to be in the context of Security Council resolution 1244 (1999).

Agreed by UNDP:

I. PURPOSE AND EXPECTED OUTPUT

According to the latest report from the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC), the Western Balkans, including Kosovo[2], is considered one of the world's hotspots for adverse climate change impacts. The region is particularly vulnerable due to its limited capacity and resources to adapt to these anticipated impacts. The urgent need to adapt to anticipated changes and mitigate risks, vulnerabilities, and economic losses is imperative, as climate change is expected to intensify and increase the frequency of extreme weather events, such as floods[3]. Kosovo is in fact already facing increasing temperatures, declining water resources, and a consistent increase in diseases, disasters and pollution all add to the burden and threat to human security, health, and well-being. The frequency of floods has increased in the last decades partly due to climate change which has increased the average temperature and precipitation in Kosovo.[4] In 2023 alone, Kosovo was heavily affected by floods resulting in loss of life, over 800 households living affected, and devastating the local community.

Kosovo heavily relies on fossil fuels, particularly coal, for its energy production which covers over 82 percent of its electricity generation[5]. This dependency on non-renewable energy sources not only contributes to high levels of air pollution but also poses significant environmental and health risks. Transitioning to renewable energy sources, such as solar and wind, is essential to mitigate the adverse effects of air pollution, reduce greenhouse gas emissions, and combat climate change. Along with the energy diversification, there is critical need to support the workforce in the path to just transition through upskilling and reskilling.

The renewable energy sector has demonstrated tremendous growth globally, offering new jobs, attracting investments, and fostering sustainable economic development. By embracing renewable energy, Kosovo can unlock not only its economic potential by creating a green economy that drives innovation, job creation, and technological advancements but also can enhance its green agenda.

Recognizing these opportunities and challenges, Kosovo has taken important steps, such as establishing the Climate Change Council, adopting the Energy Strategy, and working towards adopting the National Energy and Climate Plan and the Climate Change Law. The active green agenda of Kosovo's institutions, coupled with the obligations stemming from the Climate Change Law and the Western Balkan Green Agenda, have paved the way for the development and adoption of voluntary Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) for Kosovo, addressing pressing climate change issues.

During the first round of the Climate Promise Project - JSB, UNDP Kosovo closely collaborated with Kosovo institutions to provide the necessary technical assistance in establishing and operationalizing the Climate Change Council. The drafting of the climate change law, climate change agenda, apacity-building workshops, policy briefs, and exchange programs. Capacity building for the KCCC, technical secretariat was implemented in cooperation with counterparts in Montenegro, laying the foundation for the development of voluntary NDCs. Additionally, UNDP Kosovo, through the Climate Promise Project - JSB, responded to market needs identified in the Energy Strategy 2022-2031 by implementing a pilot activity aimed at building the capacity of unemployed youth in solar panel installation.

[2] References to Kosovo shall be understood to be in the context of Security Council resolution 1244 (1999).

[3] https://www.rferl.org/a/kosovo-floods-emergency/31042176.html

[4] https://www.meteoblue.com/en/weather/historyclimate/change/pristina_kosovo_786714

[5] https://www.ero-ks.org/zrre/sq/publikimet/raportet-vjetore

Therefore, this project proposes an urgent and integrated solution to further enhance collaboration with Kosovo institutions. It aims to continue supporting the Climate Change Council, facilitate the development of voluntary NDCs, and institutionalize the pilot course on solar installers to promote sustainable and equitable economic development in Kosovo. The project's focus will be on establishing the groundwork for mitigation and adaptation policies and green financing, aligning with Kosovo's commitment to addressing climate change challenges. By prioritizing these efforts, Kosovo can navigate the complexities of the current crises and strive towards a more sustainable future.

Output 1: Institutional capacities and coordination mechanisms at all levels strengthened to support effective, gender responsive and inclusive NDC implementation processes.

The aim is to improve institutional capacities in coordinating and implementing the green agenda this involves enhancing the capabilities and expertise of government institutions responsible for climate action and developing comprehensive frameworks for coordination and collaboration among different ministries, departments, and agencies. To ensure participation and coordination, the project will utilize capacity building events on drafting and implementing v-NDC and will involve on the process KCCC, policy makers, academia. This approach facilitates the mainstreaming of climate action across different sectors, such as energy, transportation, agriculture, and finance, ensuring a coordinated and cohesive approach to NDC implementation.

Activity 1.1: SOPs and guidelines on institutional coordination arrangement for the Kosovo Climate Change (KCCC) Council developed.

Close collaboration with relevant ministries and institutions will be a key component of this activity, aiming to develop Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) or Terms of Reference (TOR) for the Kosovo Council for Climate Change (KCCC) and the technical secretariat. These SOPs/TOR will play a crucial role in promoting gender balance and inclusivity, ensuring that diverse perspectives are represented in the coordination and development of the climate change agenda. Furthermore, this activity will provide enhanced technical assistance to the Ministry of Environment, Spatial Planning, and Infrastructure (MESPI) and the KCCC in drafting secondary legislation and/or regulations necessary for the functioning of the KCCC and the technical secretariat.

In addition to establishing SOPs/TOR, the project will focus on the development of data flow systems. These systems will facilitate the effective and efficient sharing and management of data, enabling seamless communication and collaboration between relevant institutions.

Activity 1.2: Training Reports and Training modules on NDC Implementation and Climate Finance

The activity involves organizing a series of capacity building events focused on key aspects of climate action. These events will cover topics such as drafting and implementing NDCs, as well as climate finance. The target audience for these events includes a wide range of stakeholders, including policymakers, academia, the Kosovo Council for Climate Change (KCCC), the technical secretariat, and other relevant actors. By providing training and knowledge sharing opportunities, these capacity building events will strengthen the expertise and understanding of participants, enabling them to effectively contribute to the development and implementation of climate change policies and initiatives in Kosovo.

Activity 1.3: Event report by KCCC on Climate policy and gender

This activity focuses on organizing an awareness campaign/dialogue to engage key stakeholders, vulnerable groups, women, and youth in understanding the significance of the Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) and their implementation. Through inclusive dialogues and targeted outreach, the campaign seeks to empower and involve diverse stakeholders, including vulnerable groups, women, and youth, in shaping climate action strategies and fostering a sense of ownership and responsibility towards achieving the NDC objectives. By fostering dialogue and creating a platform

for collaboration, this activity aims to build consensus, inspire action, and mobilize support for effective implementation of the NDCs in Kosovo.

Output 2: Gender Responsive Voluntary NDCs developed and approved, and CBA analysis of the measures conducted.

While not being a signatory of Paris Agreement, Kosovo is not obliged in developing and adopting NDCs. However, Kosovo institutions through the Climate Change Agenda and Climate Change Law have taken the initiative on developing voluntary NDCs. Therefore, this activity aims to support KCCC and MESPI in developing gender responsive voluntary NDCs and to develop the CVA analysis for the proposed measures.

Activity 2.1: Framework and Plan for setting a voluntary NDCs for Kosovo

This activity involves developing a framework and plan for drafting a voluntary Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) for Kosovo. Moreover, it focuses on creating a structured approach and timeline for the NDC development process. Lastly, it entails assessing past emissions trends, inventories, policies, projections, and overall background information. This assessment aims to provide a comprehensive understanding of the current climate change context in Kosovo, considering gender considerations to ensure a gender-responsive approach. The framework and assessment will guide the drafting process, ensuring that the NDC reflects the specific needs and priorities of Kosovo while addressing gender equality and inclusivity in climate action.

Activity 2.2: An inclusive voluntary NDC developed.

This activity will provide technical assistance to support the drafting of inclusive NDCs for Kosovo. This includes organizing training and knowledge exchanges for policymakers, academia, and scientists, involving experts, institutional focal points, and UNDP counterparts from the region. Furthermore, it entails analysis on the current legal framework and the policy gaps, it will identify priority measures for NDCs and will support the working group in developing a ready for approval draft. This comprehensive approach ensures that the NDCs are well-developed, inclusive, and aligned with Kosovo's climate goals, while also promoting gender equality and mainstreaming gender perspectives in climate action.

Activity 2.3: CBA analysis of the measures for the implementation of NDC

The activity involves conducting a Cost-Benefit Analysis (CBA) to evaluate the measures proposed for the implementation of the Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs). The CBA will provide a systematic assessment of the costs and benefits associated with the proposed actions, allowing for informed decision-making and prioritization of interventions. Through this analysis, the economic feasibility and potential impacts of each measure will be assessed, considering factors such as financial investment required, potential greenhouse gas emissions reduction, job creation, social co-benefits, and long-term sustainability. The CBA will provide valuable insights into the economic viability and effectiveness of different NDC measures, supporting policymakers and stakeholders in making informed choices regarding resource allocation and policy implementation. Additionally, the analysis will help identify potential trade-offs and synergies between different measures, ensuring that the most cost-effective and impactful actions are prioritized. By integrating CBA into the NDC implementation process, the activity aims to enhance the effectiveness, efficiency, and transparency of climate action strategies, facilitating the achievement of sustainable development goals while maximizing the benefits for Kosovo's economy, society, and the environment.

Output 3: Local communities and private sector are mobilized, and the just green transition is supported.

The project aims to mobilize and sensitize local communities and the private sector about the importance of the right to live in a clean and healthy environment. Through awareness campaigns and engagement activities, the project will promote the understanding of environmental rights and encourage active participation in environmental conservation efforts. Additionally, the project will focus on skill development, providing training and capacity-building initiatives to enhance the capabilities of individuals and organizations in environmental stewardship. By improving skills and knowledge, the project seeks to empower community members and the private sector to actively contribute to creating and maintaining a cleaner and healthier environment for all.

Activity 3.1: Boost x Kosovo impact accelerator, 30 businesses trained, and 10 solutions supported.

Boost X Kosovo Impact Accelerator aims to support and empower businesses in Kosovo with a focus on creating positive social and environmental impact. As part of this initiative, the program aims to train 30 businesses, equipping them with the necessary skills and knowledge to drive sustainable change. The training will cover various aspects, including business development, marketing, financial management, green transition, and impact measurement. Additionally, the program will provide support to 10 selected solutions, helping them scale and implement their innovative ideas. This support will include mentorship, access to networks and resources, and guidance on investment and funding opportunities. By nurturing and empowering these businesses, Boost X Kosovo Impact Accelerator aims to foster a thriving ecosystem of socially and environmentally responsible enterprises that contribute to the sustainable development of Kosovo.

Activity 3.2: Training Solar Installers in Kosovo, enabling the implementation of the Energy Strategy.

The project aims to enhance the capacity of the Kosovo Employment Agency and Vocational Education and Training Centers in the field of solar energy. The project will train up to four trainers from these institutions that offer courses on electrical installations. These trainers will receive specialized training on solar photovoltaic (PV) installations, equipping them with the necessary knowledge and skills to deliver high-quality training programs in this field. Furthermore, the project will support the establishment and implementation of a solar PV installers training curriculum or module within the Employment Agency. This curriculum will serve as a comprehensive guide for conducting regular training programs on solar energy, specifically focusing on PV installations. It will cover various aspects such as system design, installation techniques, safety protocols, maintenance, and troubleshooting. Aiming to enhance the current curriculum and enable regular groups of participants being trained even after the project timeline.

Activity 3.3: Implementation of UNDP Kosovo public awareness campaign on climate action and environmental engagement and implementation of Earth Days (CO traditional campaign)

The project includes the implementation of a comprehensive public awareness campaign on climate action and environmental engagement, led by UNDP Kosovo. This campaign aims to raise awareness among the public about the importance of taking action to address climate change and protect the environment. Through various communication channels such as media, social media, and community engagement activities, the campaign will disseminate key messages, educational materials, and success stories to inspire and mobilize individuals, communities, and organizations to contribute to sustainable development.

Additionally, the project will support the implementation of Earth Days, a traditional campaign focused on environmental awareness and conservation. Earth Days will serve as a platform to promote sustainable practices, encourage responsible consumption and waste management, and highlight the significance of protecting the environment for present and future generations. This campaign will engage a wide range of stakeholders, including government agencies, civil society

organizations, educational institutions, and the private sector, fostering partnerships and collaboration to maximize the impact of environmental initiatives.

Activity 3.1: Assessment of pathways to an inclusive and just green transition, by addressing critical aspects of Energy Poverty

This activity involves the assessment of key sectors related to Just Transition and Energy Poverty, the assessments will be done in close cooperation with the Ministry of Environment (MoE), Ministry of Finance and Treasury (MoFT), and Ministry of Economy. These assessments will provide valuable insights into the challenges and opportunities faced by these sectors in transitioning towards a sustainable and low-carbon economy. Furthermore, they will analyse the current state of these sectors, including their energy consumption patterns, carbon emissions, and socio-economic factors. By understanding the specific needs and barriers within each sector, tailored strategies and interventions can be developed to facilitate a just transition that promotes economic growth, decent work, and environmental sustainability.

Lastly the activity focuses on organizing round table discussions and workshops with key stakeholders on the topic of Just Transition. These platforms will bring together government agencies, industry representatives, civil society organizations, and other relevant stakeholders to engage in meaningful dialogue and collaboration.

II. MANAGEMENT ARRANGEMENTS

The project will be implemented through a direct implementation modality (DIM). The funding will therefore be fully managed by UNDP Kosovo. The Portfolio Manager from the UNDP Inclusive Growth and Climate Resilience will serve as the focal point and direct implementation to the project team responsible for the implementation of specific outputs within the project. The project analysts will be responsible for the monitoring, implementation and reporting of the interventions following the annual work plan. As needed, UNDP will provide administrative and management support for the project.

UNDP program will assuring qualitative management and results of the project. A robust project monitoring structure is critical to the success of the rehabilitation and the ability to achieve the expected project outcomes.

UNDP will work closely with affected municipalities and the responsible central institutions to ensure that the project is implemented in a coordinated and efficient manner, to achieve expected outcomes and create local ownership while inducing capacity building through the implementation.

The project will maintain high visibility and ensure continuous engagement and partnership with the project stakeholders. UNDP is a well-respected development organization in Kosovo, with an extensive network of partners and the ability to engage with a broad set of actors across sectors. In the implementation of the project, we will ensure strong communication through social media.

III. MONITORING

In accordance with UNDP's programming policies and procedures, the Initiation Plan will be monitored through the following monitoring and evaluation activities:

Quality Assurance. The quality of the project will be continuously assessed against UNDP's and partners' inputs. Quality standards will be used to identify and inform management decision-making to improve the quality and performance of the work.

Close monitoring for quality assurance will be conducted by implementing specialists and supported by the UNDP staff as deemed necessary.

Track Results Progress. Progress data against the output in the Work Plan will be collected and analysed to assess the progress of the project in achieving the agreed output. The monitoring of the project is being done by both quantitative and qualitative indicators outlined in the Framework. The project Coordinator is responsible for the collection of the indicators. Progress tracking frequency: per month.

Any quality concerns or slower-than-expected progress should be alarmed by the implementing specialist to UNDP. UNDP will conduct an internal review of data and evidence from all monitoring actions to inform decision-making.

Manage Risks. Risks are identified by UNDP management and actions are taken to manage risk. The risk log is actively maintained to keep track of identified risks and actions taken.

To minimize risks, the implementation of repairing damaged infrastructure (e.g., water pipes, sewage systems) and the monitoring and the final acceptance of the work will be done in close coordination with municipality authorities and relevant municipal departments.

Different factors contribute to the complexity of the project: a short implementation timeline, and several stakeholders' needs that might be quickly changing. A project revision shall be made when appropriate; to respond to changes in the development context or to adjust the design and resource allocation to ensure the effective and on-time implementation of the project.

IV. WORK PLAN

Period[6]:

EXPECTED OUTPUTS *And baseline, indicators including annual targets*	PLANNED ACTIVITIES *List activity results and associated actions*	TIMEFRAME				RESPONSIBLE PARTY	PLANNED BUDGET		
		Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2		Funding Source	Budget Description	Amount
Output 1: Institutional capacities and coordination mechanisms at all levels strengthened to support effective, gender responsive and inclusive NDC implementation processes.	*Activity 1.1: SOPs and guidelines on institutional coordination arrangement for the Kosovo Climate Change (KCCC) Council developed.*	X	X	X		UNDP Kosovo	CP2-Sweden	Workshops, IC contracts.	$ 30,000.00
	Activity 1.2: Training Reports and Training modules on NDC Implementation and Climate Finance		X	X	X	UNDP Kosovo	CP2-Sweden	Workshops, IC contracts.	$ 7,500.00

[6] Maximum 12 months

	Activity 1.3: Event report by KCCC on Climate policy and gender		X					Workshops, IC contracts.	$3,500.00
Output 1 Sub-Total									$41,000.00
Output 2: Gender Responsive Voluntary NDCs developed and approved, and CBA analysis of the measures conducted.	*Activity 2.1: Framework and Plan for setting a voluntary NDCs for Kosovo*	X				UNDP Kosovo	CP2-Sweden		$19,000.00
	Activity 2.2: An inclusive voluntary NDC developed.	X	X			UNDP Kosovo	CP2-Sweden		$43,000.00
	Activity 2.3: CBA analysis of the measures for the implementation of NDC		X	X	X	UNDP Kosovo	CP2-Sweden		$25,000.00
Output 2 Sub-Total									$87,000.00
Output 3: Local communities and private sector are mobilized, and the just green transition is supported.	*Activity 3.1: Boost x Kosovo impact accelerator, 30 businesses trained, and 10 solutions supported.*	X	X	X		UNDP Kosovo	CP2-Sweden		$ 90,300.00

	Activity 3.2: Training Solar Installers in Kosovo, enabling the implementation of the Energy Strategy	X	X	X	X	UNDP Kosovo	CP2-Sweden		$ 33,500.00
	Activity 3.3: Implementation of UNDP Kosovo public awareness campaign on climate action and environmental engagement and implementation of Earth Days (CO traditional campaign)			X	X	UNDP Kosovo	CP2-Sweden		$ 25,020.00
	Activity 3.4: Assessment of pathways to an inclusive and just green transition, by addressing critical aspects of Energy Poverty	X	X	X	X				$16,500.00
Output 3 Sub-Total									$ 165,320.00
Sub-Total									$ 293,320.00
	Project Analyst								$28,980.00

Project Management: Capacity in country for coordination and management of Climate Promise support established	Project Associate		$22,100.00
DPC			$ 5,600.00
General Management Support (8%)			$ 28,000.00
TOTAL			$ 378,000.00